Furthermore, not many days had passed when Hasan and Qasim Quchin arrived. Hasan was the son of the great Beg Yaq'ub. They had arrived along with other begs with the assignment to recognize the threats around Margilal and related parts. Some literature does hint that they were called on before the demise of Umar Shaikh which means that they were on task to check the advance of Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā.

According to the writings, meeting Babur had given them some kind of energy and they had put their heart and mind in holding the fort strongly.

A turbulent time was about to start for Babur.

By then, Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā had already captured Aūrā-tīpā, Khujand and Margilan (all these cities have been spoken about in the chapter on Ferghana). And then he had reached Qaba where he had been reported to have halted. This perhaps is the Kouwa railway station. It was only a few miles away from Andijān and the threat seemed very evident. Ahmad Mīrzā did indeed not have any good intentions.

The traditional narrations tell us that Darwesh Gau, then a notable person of Andijān and once an ally of Umar Shaikh, was sentenced to death for his rebellious stints. The rebellions were rising but the Gau's death brought things to rest.

The duo of Khwaja Qazi and Auzun Hasan was sent to Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā to inform him of Babur's ascension after Umar Shaikh. Auzun Hasan was a cousin of Umar Shaikh's father-in-law.

Babur mentions in the *Baburnama* that Sulṭān Ahmad was a mild man, who, for any decision, completely relied on the opinion of his begs. The proposal from Babur's end wasn't very positively replied to.

But Babur believed that Allah was by his side and circumstances prevailed as such that after having begun from Qaba, Sulṭān Ahmad's team had to stop the expedition and return.

The records say that Qaba had a stagnant morass, which one had to pass only through a bridge. Ahmad's horde was a bit too big, and slowly horses and camels started drowning in the muddy pit. They eventually perished. Babur recalls that a similar instance had occurred three years ago at the passage of Chir. It is said that a murrain[1] [2] had appeared among the horses. They massed together and death occurred in bands.

If Babur's words are to be believed, Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā also feared the loyalty of his soldiers, who would otherwise lay their lives on one say of their